Pinky's Big Break

by Brooke Anderson



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PINKY. Hi! My anatomical name is *Digitus minimus manus*. My friends call me Pinky.
JEN. Good morning! (*waves her hand*)
PINKY. (*waving back and forth*) Oh! I love the good morning wave! That's Jen. I am on her right hand. And every day me and the rest of the righties do our best to help Jen out. Wanna meet the team? They're a handful! First, there's Jen's opposable thumb.
THUMB. Alright! Look at me! This is awesome! You're awesome!
PINKY. He's our team cheerleader. He's strong, and confident, and he is awesome at hitching us a ride. But he's kinda far away. Then, there's Jen's index finger.
INDEX. YOU! What are you looking at? Get back to work!
PINKY. He's our number one! He's the director. He's very encouraging…and accusatory. It's complicated. Then there's Jen's middle finger. He's the conflict manager…
MIDDLE. AHHHHH!
PINKY. We don't talk to him much. And then we have Jen's ring finger.
RING. Hi, you wanna be friends? Wanna be…more than friends?
PINKY. She's the relationship expert. And then there's me. My job is…well, that's just the problem: I don't really do anything. But all that changes today. Because today is the day that I, Jen's right Pinky, take over the world! Or at least become more handy.

We all know what it means to overlook our own greatness and to sacrifice our identity to be popular. I mean, we all know it, but what about (looks at hand)...them. For one little pinky finger who is tired of experiencing life second-hand, the time has come, to rise...and be counted. Pinky's Big Break *by Brooke Anderson*

THUMB. Hey, Pink, what's that you're saying?
PINKY. You heard me, Thumb. I just can't take it anymore.
INDEX. Aren't you being a little dramatic?
PINKY. No, I'm not. Need I remind you of what happened yesterday?

FLASHBACK

JEN. Yeah, thanks for calling. (*hangs up phone*) Man, I've got something in my ear… (*starts to put pinky in ear to scratch it*)
PINKY. NO!!!!!
JEN. Nope. Just wax, I guess.
PINKY. Ugh. It's like there's Vaseline everywhere.

FLASHFORWARD

INDEX. Now that…was very gross.
PINKY. I'm aware.
THUMB. Aw, chin up, Pinky. It's not always that bad. There was that one time you got to wear that cool metal cape for a while!

PINKY. You mean when someone slammed me in a car door and I was broken in three places?

THUMB. Oh, right. Well, at least things can't get any worse than that! And hey, we're going to see Annie later this week!

PINKY. Annie! Annie is Jen's niece. She's the greatest. She's the only one who loves me. When they drink tea like proper English women, that's my shining moment. But Annie's getting older. She's almost eight and tea parties hardly ever happen anymore.

RING. And then you'll be all alone. Like me. I JUST NEED LOVE!

PINKY. See, Ring gets it! If I don't assert myself and become more useful, I'll shrivel up and die.

THUMB. Okay, so what's your plan?

PINKY. Well, the way I see it, there are three main criteria for a proper digit: utility, communication, and dexterity. Currently, I…possess none of these. But just you wait, soon the world will be wrapped around this little finger.

TRANSITION – JEN'S BED

JEN. (*Sleeping. The alarm goes off.*)

PINKY. It's time! (*Pinky moves as if possessed, hits the alarm. The alarm changes to a more annoying sound. Pinky panics and hits it again. It becomes the radio*.)

JEN. (*finally wakes up*) Huh!? What was that?

PINKY. A strong start, that's what that was! Already I'm feeling like the favorite. Righties, did you see me? Did you see me?

INDEX. Yeah, I saw you. You hit every button except snooze. You didn't even know which button to push.

THUMB. Easy there, Pointer. Pinky's doing a great job. I mean, totally wrong, but still great.

PINKY. Well, just you wait. I've got plenty of utility to pack into these knuckles!

TRANSITION – JEN'S KITCHEN

JEN. (*on the phone, making breakfast*) Yeah, I'll be in right after breakfast, Gary. No, I just woke up late. Something weird happened with my alarm clock and… (*goes to push the microwave button, but it's Pinky again*)

PINKY. (*ramming his head into the button*) Utility! Utility! Utility!

JEN. I don't even know what's going on today…

INDEX. Pinky! Did you just do my job? No one does my job.

PINKY: Don't get all bent out of shape.

INDEX: No, that's your job apparently. I'm the king of the microwave buttons! Except when I have a hang nail, and then middle finger does it.

MIDDLE. AHHHHH!

PINKY. Okay, I'm sorry. I didn't mean to intrude. I just wanted to be more useful.

INDEX. Well, be useful somewhere else.
PINKY. Okay. So utility isn't my thing.
THUMB. There's more to being a finger than utility, Pinky.
PINKY. You're right! Like communication! Maybe a pinky could be great for gestures and stuff. Might as well try my hand at it…

TRANSITION – JEN'S CAR

JEN. Ugh, I'm so late for work. I just can't even. Yikes! (*almost gets hit by a car*) - AH! - You jerk! (*flips off the driver, but Pinky jumps up too*) What the?
PINKY. I TOO FIND FAULT WITH YOUR DRIVING, SIR!
MIDDLE. AHHHH! What are you doing?
PINKY. I was adding emphasis.
MIDDLE. I AM EMPHASIS.
PINKY. Well, maybe he thought it was a gang sign and he will freak out.
MIDDLE. I hope you get a paper cut.
PINKY. That's a horrible thing to say.
THUMB. Don't listen to him, Pinky. He's just…him. I tell you what, why don't you and I team up.
PINKY. Do you mean it?
THUMB. You bet. After all, dexterity is a team sport!

TRANSITION – JEN'S OFFICE

JEN. I'll have that report to you ASAP, Gary. Just having a rough day.
THUMB. Ready, Pinky?
PINKY. Ready!
THUMB. LET'S DO THIS!
JEN. (*Jen writes, but with the thumb and the pinky. It's awkward.*) I can't…what the…ENOUGH! (*looks at hand*) What is going on?
PINKY. She's looking right at me.
JEN. Quit being weird!
PINKY. Oh, okay.
THUMB. Awww, buddy. I'm sorry.
INDEX. Pinky, you're just not meant to do all that stuff.
RING. Maybe it's okay that no one loves you.
PINKY. Yeah. Maybe…

TRANSITION – JEN'S HOUSE

THUMB. Hey look, Annie's here!
ANNIE. Hi, Auntie Jen.
JEN. Hi, kiddo! How've you been?
ANNIE. I don't think anyone in my class likes me.
JEN. What? I'm sure that's not true.
ANNIE. Yea-huh. I'm not strong, or good at talking to people, and I don't write good.
PINKY. Preach it, sister.

ANNIE. And Ralphie Pederson said I was weird.

JEN. Well, I happen to think you have a lovely writing.

ANNIE. You do?

JEN. Yes, I do. People are good at different things, but nobody can tell you how valuable you are. You just have to be you because that's my favorite.

ANNIE. Promise (*holds up her pinky for a pinky promise*).

PINKY. Guys, looks! Look what she's doing!

ANNIE. It's a pinky promise. It means you swear forever. No matter what.

JEN. I promise.

PINKY. (*leans forward and completes the promise*) Wow. So I may not be the strongest, coolest, or most useful, but I am the best version of me there is. Hands down.